

Chapter 1

A bridge above a wild river. Cars drive by. A teenage girl stands at the barrier. She looks tired and wears black baggy pants and a black vest. Slowly the girl moves closer and closer to the edge of the bridge. She looks down and looks at her phone one last time. 0 notifications. Then she climbs over the fence. She looks at her wrists and closes her eyes.

Then she jumps.

"BEEP BEEP BEEP BEEP BEE-"

"Ugh" Sylvia says as she stops her alarm. She looks at her watch. 6:30 am. Why did she choose this school again? After a few minutes she gets out of bed. How late did she go to sleep? Quickly she dresses up and checks what lessons she has. Math, French, geography and biology. Sylvia goes downstairs to the living room. Bottles, empty wine bottles everywhere. Her mother is probably still asleep.

7:12 am.

“Shit!” Sylvia grabs her bag and runs outside. She needs to catch her bus. After running 3 minutes she sees the bus in the distance. “Wait! Wait for me!” She shouts. Getting closer, closer, just 5 more meters...

“Yes” She has made it to the bus and sits down. Why is she so excited to catch the bus? Its not like school is any fun. In fact, she’d rather never go to school again. But her teachers are already watching her closely, they know where she lives and if she doesn’t arrive at school they’d certainly wait at her house, and when her mother would hear the news that would mean-

“End stop! Everyone out!” The bus driver shouts.

“There you are, Sylvia. Just in time.” The teacher says. Sylvia walks to her seat, next to Sam.

“Late again, fatty” Sam whispers. “Eventually the teachers will stop keeping an eye shut, I hope they’ll give you detention”

Sylvia doesn’t react. She’s thinking about last night. She remembers her mom coming home late at night, and she was drunk. Really drunk. She got mad at Sylvia

because she didn't clean the living room. She remembers sitting in her room, Crying. And she remembers the lonely feeling. Like no one would notice if she would just... Disappear. She remembers the pain. The urge. The blood.

It's become a given that Sylvia wears long sleeves. No one questions it. Probably because no one cares. Sometimes Sylvia wishes someone would ask: "Why do you always cover your arms? Are you okay?" But why would anyone ask that? She's just the weird kid, The fat kid, The kid to make fun of. She's the oldest of her class. She's almost 15, while most other kids are 13 or just became 14.

"And, Sylvia, can you explain the formula to us?"

"Um- uh- well..." Sylvia stutters.

"Well surely you did your homework, Right?" The entire class looks at her.

"That's the fifth time this month. I'd like to talk to you when this hour's over, Sylvia Evans."

"How is it going-"

"Fine."

"Okay, then why don't you ever do your homework?"

The teacher looks deep into Sylvia's eyes. She has glasses, those typical teacher glasses that are rectangular. Sylvia guesses her age at around 60 years old.

"Um, I just- forgot it."

That's not true. She was lying in her bed because she was exhausted from school. And when she finally wanted to start her homework, Her mom came home and-

"How is your home situation?" Her teacher asked, as if she could read Sylvia's mind.

"Fine." She replied, again a little too fast.

"Your father isn't home that much, right?"

"My dad's dead."

"Oh, that must be very painful for you." Her teacher says empathically, though she doesn't look very empathic.

"Nah, when he died I was only 5."

Again, not true. He died 2 years ago, just before she would go to high school.

"And your mother? Does she care well for you?"

"Of course! Why are you so worried about my home situation?"

Sylvia already knows the answer. Her mother once went to school to hear about Sylvia's bad grades, completely drunk.

"Oh, I'm just curious why your grades have been going down so bad. In the first year you were getting straight A's, but now you might not make it to third year."

Sylvia bites her lip. If she'd fail this year her mother would personally hang her on the highest tree. And that might just be the best way to deal with a daughter like her.

Chapter 2

RINGGG!

"Yes, finally!" Sylvia thinks. Though it really just is going from one hell to another. She still hasn't decided what's worse: home or school. She walks through the hall, on

the way to the lockers.

"There she is again: Miss fatty!"

"I've heard she's a lesbian!"

"Ha! As if girls would want her! She doesn't even have normal friends!"

Sometimes Sylvia would want to come to school with a gun one day, and shoot every bully she sees. And when the police arrive, she'd shoot herself in the head. Sadly getting a gun isn't easy. And even if she did have a gun she wouldn't have the courage to actually hurt people.

In the bus Sylvia thinks about what those kids said. Maybe she is lesbian. She had never had a crush on a boy, but also never on a girl. One thing she knows for sure is that she's fat. And she also doesn't have any friends. She used to have lots of friends, in middle school. But they all went to other schools. She failed her last exam before high school because her father died. Her mother was never the same after that. She started using alcohol to numb the pain. Her mom used to be very kind. Sylvia remembers her mom playing with her, and feeding ducks in the park together. Now she's just a volcano that sleeps most of the time but sometimes

erupts. What would her mother do if she died? She'd probably just drink more alcohol, that's her way to deal with every problem. That is, thinking her mother would care. She probably wouldn't care if she'd be gone. No one would.

Sylvia looks at her watch. 02:23 am. Her mom is already asleep. She got drunk again and now she's laying on the couch. Sylvia is hungry. Has she even eaten? She can't remember. She runs downstairs and opens the fridge. Wine, wine, wine, wine. No food? She checks all of the little cabinets, but she only found some chocolate and an old 16-pack of ice lollies. "No, don't eat that! You're already fat enough!" A voice in her head says. But she's so hungry... Well, just one piece of chocolate won't hurt, right?

"Ugh" Sylvia feels dirty. As if she stepped in a big pile of cow dung. She has ate all of the chocolate and 14 ice lollies.

"You will always stay a fatty, you can't even control yourself" The voice says. "If you can't stop the urge, Then we'll do it this way."

4:02 am. Sylvia is laying on her bed. Her left arm is covered in blood, and so is her bed. But who even cares. It's not like her mother ever comes into her room. Her mouth tastes weird. Making yourself puke was easier than she thought. She hears noise downstairs.

"Shit! That's probably mom" Sylvia thinks. She slowly sneaks to her door to close it. Then she hears her mom open the back door.

"What?" She thinks. Her mother just walked out, at 4 am.

Chapter 3

Lunch break. Sylvia hasn't brought lunch with her. She sits in the corner of the hall, drawing in a book, listening to music. She looks up. A girl is standing in front of her.

"Nice drawing!" She says.

"Um, th- thanks!" Sylvia walks away.

"Hey! Can you teach me how to draw like that?" The girl asks.

“Uh- well-” Something about this girl makes Sylvia feel weird. Uncomfortable and comfortable at the same time.

RINGGG!

“Sorry, maybe later!” Sylvia says to her as she walks to her classroom.

“What did you do? Finally someone actually talks to you normally, and you just fuck it all up! Now she probably thinks you’re just a weird asocial kid.” Its that voice again.

“Can’t you just shut up? I’m trying my best” Sylvia says back.

“Ha, Miss fatty talks to air! Too bad you don’t have real friends!”

Sylvia doesn’t even react. She used to react to those people, but it only made it worse.

Her mom wasn’t home in the morning. Sylvia wonders where she could have gone. Wouldn’t it be nice if she never returned? Then Sylvia would have the house all for herself. There wouldn’t be a mother that would hit Sylvia if she was drunk.

Sylvia thinks about what happened in the lunch break.

That girl actually gave her a compliment! But why does she feel so weird around that girl? Maybe they can become friends?

"No, because you stuttered the entire time and just acted like a weirdo" The voice says.

RINGGG!

Sylvia walks through the halls, ignores the usual shouting, and opens the door to the lockers.

"Hey! You!" Sylvia looks to her left and sees the girl again.

Sylvia stops and says back: "Hi, uhh, do you still want to learn how to draw?"

"Don't fuck this up now" The voice in the back of her head says.

"Sure! Can we go to your house?" She asks. "My name is Jamie, by the way"

"My name is Sylvia! But no, can we go to your house, or maybe stay at school"

"Yeah, we can stay at school if you want, Sylvia" Jamie says.

"Bye! See you tomorrow!" Jamie waves to Sylvia as she walks away to her bus.

"Bye!"

"Holy shit! I think you finally managed to get a friend!"

The voice says.

What even is that voice? Are there really people in Sylvia's head, or is it just her thoughts?

Sylvia feels glad Jamie didn't look at her other drawings in her book. She usually draws lonely, depressed scenes. But this lunch break she decided to draw a normal person in high detail and make a character out of it.

"How late is it?" Sylvia thinks.

05:46 pm.

"Shit! I need to get home by 6!"

Back at her house she opens the door. Its 06:16 pm.

"Mom?" Sylvia shouts.

No answer.

"Mom? I'm home!"

No answer again.

Sylvia walks upstairs to her mother's sleeping room. There she lays. Her mother, deep sleeping, probably drunk. But then, on the floor next to her mother's bedside drawer, she sees a small bottle.

"Sleeping medication..." Sylvia gasps. The bottle is half empty.

"911, what is your emergency?" Sounds through the phone.

"My mom, she- I think she committed suicide!" Sylvia is crying. She thought it'd be better if her mom was gone, but now that she thinks about it...

"Calm down ma'am, are you safe right now?"

"Yes"

"What's your location?"

"Wisher street 34 in Manhattan" Sylvia replies.

"Okay, we have vehicles coming in your direction, they'll be there in 5 minutes."

Chapter 4

Sylvia is asleep, in a chair next to her mother's bed in the

hospital. Again, she dreams about the bridge. Now that her mother's probably dead, she might as well make an end to it too. The doctors said that her mother was in critical condition. She had, of course, taken an overdose on sleeping medication.

Sylvia wakes up at 11:03 am. She looks to her right and sees her mother. She looks so... Helpless, so childish. Then one thought hits her: "What about the price?" Medical care isn't free, how will they ever pay this? They were never rich, but now they're at a low point. Her mom spends all her money on wine, and Sylvia just eats microwave food. If she even eats at all. They're already in debt, and if they have to pay for this too...

Her mom turns around in her bed. Sylvia looks up.

Her mom looks around the hospital room.

"Hey, Sylv, are you here too?" She says with a sleepy voice.

"Yes, without me you'd be-" Sylvia stops mid sentence. Should she say this? Maybe her mom has lost memory and she can tell her mom that she's the best mom ever and never drinks.

"I'd be... dead." Her mom replies.

There's an awkward silence between the two.

"Yes, you almost were"

"Why did you bring me here? If it had just worked it would all be over. But now we have to pay a shit ton of money because we don't have health insurance!" Her mom looks angry.

"As if I'm happy to be alive!" Sylvia replies.

Her mother looks her in the eyes.

"You. Should. Be. Happy. To. Be. Alive." Her mother looks like she's about to explode of anger.

Sylvia walks out of the room.

"I hope they cut your live support!" She shouts.

Sylvia walks away from the hospital. There's a bridge over a small river that's 2 kilometers away.

Should she go? Should she just end it, now that she can?

"Yes, walk to the bridge and jump" The voice says.

She's been dreaming about this type of thing for months.

"But Jamie... She seemed so kind!" Sylvia says to back to herself.

“Jamie has enough friends. She probably only approached you because she feels sorry for you. Jump”

Sylvia has arrived at the bridge. There’s lots of people walking by. She looks at her phone. 0 notifications. No one wondering if she’s okay, no one sending a random meme, no one who cares. Should she jump? She stands at the edge of the bridge, against the fencing. She looks down to the water below.

“No. I’m not jumping.” Sylvia thinks.

“Yes you are, do you want to suffer even more? Quick, end it. Now!” Why is she debating in her head?

PING! A notification pops up on her phone.

[unknown number]: Hi Sylvia! (I’m Jamie btw)

Is that really Jamie? How did she get her number?

You: Hi! How did u get my number?

[unknown number]: Via the school administration. I was worried cuz u weren’t at school

You: Yeah sorry there’s something with my mom but ill be at school tomorrow!

Jamie: Ok!

Jamie: Wanna come over to my house?

Sylvia feels tired and is still standing at the edge of the bridge.

You: No sorry maybe later im really tired ._.

Jamie: Dw, ill see u tomorrow!

Sylvia starts walking back home.

PING!

Jamie: What happened to ur mom then?

Sylvia turns off her phone again.

Jamie: I can see that u read my message. What happened to ur mom??

Jamie: Sylvia?

You: Ill tell u later sorry

Sylvia is staring at Jamie's profile picture. Jamie looks beautiful in that picture. Her long blonde hair shines in the sunlight and her kind eyes stare right into the camera. Sylvia thinks. Why does she feel so weird around Jamie? And why did she say no? She'd love to go to Jamie's house.

"Well, no is no. You fucked up" The annoying voice says.